

Reading User Input With Scanner

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What We'll Learn

By the end of this lesson, students can:

- Import and create a Scanner object.
- Use Scanner methods to read user input.
- Store user input in appropriate variables.
- Display the information entered by the user.

Before We Start

Think about programs that ask users to enter their name, age, score, or other information.

Why does a program need to receive information from the user?

Let's Understand

Java uses the Scanner class to read information entered through the keyboard.

Before using Scanner, we must import it:

```
import java.util.Scanner;
```

Inside the main method, create a Scanner object:

```
Scanner input = new Scanner(System.in);
```

Common Scanner methods include:

- `nextLine()` – reads a line of text
- `nextInt()` – reads a whole number
- `nextDouble()` – reads a decimal number
- `nextBoolean()` – reads true or false

The input should be stored in a variable with the correct data type.

```
String name = input.nextLine();  
int age = input.nextInt();  
double grade = input.nextDouble();
```

Display a prompt before reading input so the user knows what to enter.

```
System.out.print("Enter your name: ");  
String name = input.nextLine();
```

Close the Scanner when it is no longer needed.

```
input.close();
```

Let's Practice

Create a Java program that asks the user to enter:

- Full name
- Grade level
- Favorite subject

Store each answer in an appropriate variable. Display the information using the following format:

```
Student Profile
Name: Juan Dela Cruz
Grade Level: 11
Favorite Subject: Computer Programming
```

Let's Reflect

Why is it important to use the correct Scanner method for the type of data being entered?